LESSON 12

Past Simple

We use the Past Simple to talk about:

- actions and situations which happened and finished in the past

Peter **finished** his homework and **visited** his grandmother.

I **bought** a new dress yesterday.

Last year we **spent** our holiday in Rome.

- habitual actions in the past

Every day we **woke** up at 7 and **went** sightseeing.

George regularly **had** a cup of coffee before breakfast.

They always **went** to school by bus.

Time expressions often used with the Past Simple: yesterday (morning/evening), last year/month/week/Monday/night, in (May/1968/the 1990s), ago, on (day/morning).

Formation rules (also see the tables below):

- **regular verbs:** add ***-d*** or ***-ed*** to the infinitive (e.g. love – loved, want – wanted)
- **irregular verbs:** use their 2nd form (e.g. sleep – slept, go – went, drink – drank)

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- **verbs ending with an *-y***: in spelling -y turns into -ie in most of the cases (e.g. study – studied, say – said)

- **negatives** are formed with *did not* and the bare infinitive

I **did not like** the film. *or* I **didn't like** the film.

I **did not sleep** well last night. *or* I **didn't sleep** well last night.

Peter **did not help** me. *or* Peter **didn't help** me.

- **questions** are formed with *did* and the bare infinitive

Did you like this book?

Did you sleep well?

Where **did** Peter study?

Affirmative

I You He/She/(It) We You They	listened	to music.

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Negative

I You He/She/(It) We You They	did not (didn't) listen	to music.

Interrogative

Did	I you he/she/(it) we you they	listen	to music?

The past tense of ***to be***

Affirmative

I He/She/(It)	was	happy.
We You They	were	

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Negative

I He/She/(It)	was not (wasn't)	happy.
We You They	were not (weren't)	

Interrogative

Was	I he/she/(it)	happy?
Were	we you they	

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